

CONSENT TO BE PART OF A RESEARCH STUDIES ON THIS PLATFORM

- Platform Title: The Morality Game
- Platform Creator: Gregory Stanley, Ph.D. Candidate, University of Michigan
- Faculty Advisor: Jun Zhang, Professor of Psychology, University of Michigan

Thank you for your interest in participating in experiments hosted on this platform. This form contains information about the platform as a whole, rather than individual experiments. Please read this entire form before deciding whether to take part in any experiments hosted here. Individual experiments will have specific consent forms that complement this general consent form.

You must be 18 years of age or older to participate in studies on this platform.

KEY INFORMATION

The aim of the platform is to facilitate research on factors that reduce and promote cooperation. Experiments involve interactive online social dilemmas, across multiple rounds, involving predictions and choices about the distribution of rewards between participants. In paid experiments, participants are paid proportionally to the rewards they accrued. Unpaid experiments provide proof of completion for university course credit.

- Risks: There are no foreseeable risks of participating.
- Data Security: All data is stored securely and anonymously.
- Duration: You will be informed about the expected duration of each study.
- Stopping: There is no penalty for not finishing, but completion is required for credit or payment.
- Continuous Participation: We encourage participation in multiple studies from various researchers as it increases the value of the data.
- 18+ Years Old: You must be 18 years of age or older to participate in studies on this platform.

PURPOSE OF THIS PLATFORM

This platform aims to increase the quality of research on cooperation by standardizing methods, consolidating open-access data, and facilitating the rapid deployment of experiments. While the interests individual researchers may vary, the overall goal of this platform is to investigate factors that reduce and promote cooperation.

WHAT WILL HAPPEN TO ME ON THIS PLATFORM?

- **Online Participation:** All experiments are conducted on this website. Digital avatars represent each participant. Across multiple rounds, participants are matched and rematched with other participants in social dilemmas, involving timed choices and predictions of other's choices.
- **Tutorials and Levels:** Tutorials must be completed in sequence, unlocking corresponding experiments. Tutorials are interactive and last about four minutes each. Inactivity over two minutes automatically results in you being ejected from the experiment.
- **Debriefing and Payment:** Debriefing forms, payment or credit, and downloadable completion URLs are provided at the end of each experiment. If you signed up for this study on SONA, then you will receive completion credit, not payment.

ENDING THE STUDY

All data is automatically stored on Amazon Web Services servers and the personal computer(s) of the responsible researcher. Unique randomized participant IDs enable anonymity and data comparison across studies. For paid experiments, payments will be deposited directly. The system automatically sends proof of completion to the responsible researcher and the human subject pool administrators of your university or institution if the researcher enables this feature. The system provides you a proof of completion URL as a manual fallback in case of technical failure.

IF I WANT TO STOP PARTICIPATING IN THIS STUDY, WHAT SHOULD I DO?

You are free to leave the study at any time, without penalty. If you share your reasons, they may become part of our record. The researchers will keep the information collected about you for the research unless you ask us to delete it from our records. If the researchers have already used your information in a research analysis it will not be possible to remove your information. To leave a study, click the 'Exit Experiment' button at the top of the screen and confirm.

HOW WILL THE RESEARCHERS PROTECT MY INFORMATION?

Your name will not be used in conjunction with the results of the experiment, and all information about your performance will be kept strictly confidential. Your data is stored with a randomly generated user ID, absent of your name or any other information that can directly identify you. The results of this study could be published in an article or presentation but will not include any information that would let others know who you are. We may use or share your research information for future research studies. If we share your information with other researchers, it will remain de-identified. This research may be like this study or completely different. We will not ask for your additional informed consent for these studies.

CONTACT INFORMATION

Questions, concerns, or the wish to leave a study should be directed to the researchers configuring the experiment. Platform-related queries can be directed to:

- Platform Creator: Gregory Stanley; Phone: (714) 454-0435; Email: gregstan@umich.edu
- Faculty Advisor: Jun Zhang; Phone: (734) 763-6161; Email: junz@umich.edu

To express concern about a study, contact University of Michigan Health Sciences and Behavioral Sciences Institutional Review Board, 2800 Plymouth Road, Building 520, Room 1169 Ann Arbor, MI 48109. Call: 734-936-0933 or toll free 866-936-0933; Fax: 734-936-1852; E-mail: irbhsbs@umich.edu. You can also contact the University of Michigan Compliance Hotline at (866) 990-0111.

The University of Michigan Institutional Review Board Health Sciences and Behavioral Sciences has determined that this platform is exempt from IRB oversight, but individual researchers must submit proof of IRB approval before deploying experiments.

YOUR CONSENT

I understand that my participation in the studies described above is entirely voluntary, and I hereby agree to be a participant on this platform.